

5 Works of scholars	5.1	Comparative study of Maimonides and Moses Mendelssohn (3) (4) a) The different contexts to Maimonides and Moses Mendelssohn. b) The strengths and weaknesses of these scholars within Judaism. c) Their contributions to an understanding of modern Judaism. - o Maimonides: his basic teachings of Judaism, including 'The Thirteen Principles of Faith'. Noted for juridical works on the Pentateuch, Arabic commentary on the Mishnah and his codification of the Talmudic Law and especially the Guide to the Perplexed. Implications for belief and practice, ethics, scholarly debates, including his proofs for the existence of God and beliefs about creation, rejecting Greek philosophy, importance of prophecy, and contributions to the development of Judaism. - o Moses Mendelssohn: translation of the Torah and the Psalms into German, linked to observance of Halakhah coupled with rationalism; arguments for immortality as unending moral progress. Harmony between revealed law and reason and similar approach in his argument for the existence of God and in support of freewill. Significance of Jewish practices to sustain Israel's loyalty to God and influence on Haskalah, linked to European enlightenment, and acculturation and assimilation to the larger culture; critics such as Hatam Sofer. With reference to the ideas of D Cohn-Sherbok and G Robinson.
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